

BOT THAT LYFE · SEASON 1

SEASON ONE

WHERE YOU AT
be honest about where you
WHERE YOU TRYING TO GET
say where you're going, or
HOW YOU GETTING THERE
wide, deep, or love — and

VIEWER STUDY GUIDE

SEARCH PARTY

Faith, AI, and finding your path — Where you at? Where you trying to get to? How you getting there?

Three college students in an Agentic AI class are searching for God three different ways — wide, deep, and not at all. Their class teaches graph search; their lives become one. They find out the White Jesus, the Black Jesus and the chakra being Chen meditates with are faces of one Light — teleport their minds to two futures — and bring the good one home. An animated comedy about faith, identity, AI and three questions: Where you at? Where you trying to get to? How you getting there?

How to use this guide

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Each episode is 5:04–5:58 long (32 minutes for the season). Watch it with friends, then work the matching pages: the big idea, what's underneath it (scripture, history and a little science), the terms, one activity, a page to journal, and the questions to talk through.

THE SEASON



EPISODE 1 · 5:58
Where You At?



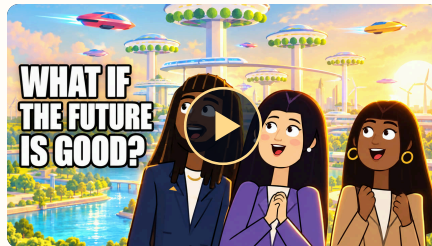
EPISODE 2 · 5:07
Breadth First



EPISODE 3 · 5:34
Same Light



EPISODE 4 · 5:16
Teleport



EPISODE 5 · 5:04
The Jetsons Branch



EPISODE 6 · 5:21
Light Speed

Watch the season: <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLe6cqmeTKuo>

THE CAST

Dre — EECS junior · church kid · searches breadth-first

Nia — Religious-studies minor · brings receipts · stuck at the start node

Dr. Mei — Teaches EECS 498: Agentic AI · has read the paper

Jesus (two portrayals) — Dramatized portrayals with original dialogue — kind, funny, the same Light

Chen — EECS + cognitive science · meditates · sees the spirit world · searches depth-first

Brent — Lit for Christ worship leader · fog machine enthusiast

Ms. Lorraine & Pastor Greene — Greater New Light Missionary Baptist · the church family

The Operator — The chakra being · narrator · Chen's guide



EPISODE 1

Where You At?

5:58 · Search Party · a Bot That Lyfe study

You can't find a path from a place you won't admit you're **standing** in.

WHAT IT'S ABOUT

- Why the White Jesus on so many church walls is a painting with a history, not a photograph
- What John 14:6 and Revelation 1:14–15 actually say — read in context
- The three things every agent (and every person) needs: a state, a goal, a path

WORDS TO KNOW

State

Where you're at — what's true right now, honestly described.

Goal

Where you're trying to get — what 'done' looks like, said out loud.

Path

How you're getting there — the steps between the two.

Head of Christ

Warner Sallman's 1940 painting, reproduced hundreds of millions of times — the face many churches still hang.

INSIDE THE LIGHT — SCRIPTURE, HISTORY, SCIENCE

Jesus was a first-century Jew from Galilee; the blue-eyed portrait came much later. Historians Edward Blum and Paul Harvey trace how American images of Christ took on whiteness. John 14:6 ('I am the way, the truth, and the life: no man cometh unto the Father, but by me') is about the way, not a face. Revelation 1:14–15 — hair 'white like wool', feet 'like unto fine brass, as if they burned in a furnace' — is a vision of glory read many ways.

ACTIVITY

Where you at? (the honest map)

1. Write the image of God you grew up with — where you saw it, who handed it to you.
2. Write what you actually believe today, in one plain sentence. No church voice.
3. Write where you're trying to get — and one small step you could take this week.

JOURNAL THIS

WHERE I'M AT: _____
WHERE I'M TRYING TO GET: _____
HOW I'M GETTING THERE: _____
ONE STEP THIS WEEK: _____

TALK ABOUT IT

- ☐ What image of Jesus did you grow up with? How did it make you feel?
- ☐ Dre calls 'only through him' a VIP line. Is that fair? What else could 'the way' mean?
- ☐ Nia agrees with Dre and still loves her church. Can both be true for you?
- ☐ Where are you honestly at right now?

Sources. John 14:6; Revelation 1:14–15 (King James Version) · Blum, E. J. & Harvey, P. (2012). The Color of Christ: The Son of God and the Saga of Race in America. UNC Press. · Sallman, W. (1940). Head of Christ.



EPISODE 2

Breadth First

5:07 · Search Party · a Bot That Lyfe study

Wide is how you learn what's out there. Deep is how you learn what's real. And you need to know when to **stop**.

WHAT IT'S ABOUT

- Breadth-first vs depth-first search — and which one you're doing with your life
- Why Ethiopian Christian art has painted Christ dark-skinned for centuries
- What a meditating brain does (theta) — and what binaural-beat science does and doesn't say

WORDS TO KNOW

Breadth-first search (BFS)

Check everything one step away before going further. A queue. Wide and careful — and shallow.

Depth-first search (DFS)

Follow one road to its end before trying another. A stack. Fast and deep — and easy to get lost in.

Theta rhythm

Brain activity around 4–8 cycles a second, often seen in deep relaxation and meditation.

INSIDE THE LIGHT — SCRIPTURE, HISTORY, SCIENCE

Christianity reached the Kingdom of Aksum (today's Ethiopia and Eritrea) in the 4th century, and Ethiopian Orthodox icons have long shown Christ, Mary and the saints with Ethiopian features — 'every people paints the face they know.' Deep meditation is linked with slower brain rhythms like theta; binaural beats are studied for attention and anxiety, with mixed results. Dr. Mei's line is the lesson: breadth-first without a goal is sightseeing; depth-first without a check is falling.

ACTIVITY

Map your search

1. List every 'node' you've tried in your search — churches, podcasts, practices, people.
2. Mark each one: how deep did you actually go? (visited / stayed a while / committed)
3. Circle the one worth going deeper on, and write your stopping rule for it.

JOURNAL THIS

MY SEARCH STYLE: wide (BFS) / deep (DFS) / stuck at the start
GOING DEEPER ON: _____
I'LL KNOW I'M THERE WHEN: _____
I'LL TURN AROUND IF: _____

TALK ABOUT IT

- ☐ Are you more Dre (wide), Chen (deep) or Nia (stuck)?
- ☐ What did the icon chapel teach Dre that eleven parking lots didn't?
- ☐ What's your stopping rule — for prayer, for study, for scrolling?

Sources. Cormen, Leiserson, Rivest & Stein. Introduction to Algorithms — breadth-first and depth-first search. · Garcia-Argibay, M., Santet, M. A. & Reales, J. M. (2019). Efficacy of binaural auditory beats in cognition, anxiety, and pain perception: a meta-analysis. Psychological Research.



EPISODE 3

Same Light

5:34 · Search Party · a Bot That Lyfe study

The face is not the point. The **Light** is.

WHAT IT'S ABOUT

- What the Bible says God is — light and spirit — beyond any painted face
- What most historians agree about the historical Jesus
- Brains and neural networks: patterns of electrical activity, in carbon and in silicon

WORDS TO KNOW

Manifestation

A way something unseen shows up so people can recognize it.

Neuron

A brain cell that passes electrochemical signals; your brain has about 86 billion.

Artificial neural network

Software made of simple connected units whose connection strengths are learned from data — electrical patterns on silicon.

INSIDE THE LIGHT — SCRIPTURE, HISTORY, SCIENCE

'God is light, and in him is no darkness at all' (1 John 1:5). 'God is a Spirit' (John 4:24). 'In him we live, and move, and have our being' (Acts 17:28). Most historians agree Jesus was a first-century Galilean Jew — so likely brown-skinned with Middle Eastern features. Brains run on electrochemical patterns across roughly 86 billion neurons; artificial neural networks run on electrical patterns in silicon. The show plays with that likeness for laughs and wonder; it's a metaphor, not a doctrine.

ACTIVITY

Same Light

1. Write down three images of God you've been handed (a painting, a voice, a feeling).
2. Next to each, write what it points to — what it's trying to show you.
3. Write one sentence about the Light underneath all three.

JOURNAL THIS

THE IMAGE I WAS HANDED: _____
WHAT IT POINTS TO: _____
THE LIGHT UNDERNEATH: _____

TALK ABOUT IT

- ☐ Why do you think both Jesuses said they were 'close'?
- ☐ Does 'God is light' change how you hear John 14:6?
- ☐ Dre asks 'So I'm a chatbot?' — what's the difference between a person and a pattern?

Sources. 1 John 1:5; John 4:24; Acts 17:28 (King James Version) · Azevedo, F. A. C. et al. (2009). Equal numbers of neuronal and nonneuronal cells make the human brain an isometrically scaled-up primate brain. *J. Comp. Neurology*. · Sanders, E. P. (1993). *The Historical Figure of Jesus*. Penguin.



EPISODE 4

Teleport

5:16 · Search Party · a Bot That Lyfe study

The future is a graph, and we're choosing the edges **right now**.

WHAT IT'S ABOUT

- How engagement-optimized feeds can amplify outrage and division
- Why 'what is this optimizing?' is the most important question about any AI system
- Futures as a state space: every habit is an edge

WORDS TO KNOW

Objective (metric)

What a system is built to maximize. Change the metric, change the world it builds.

Engagement optimization

Ranking content by what keeps people watching, clicking and sharing.

Filter bubble

A feed that keeps showing you what your side already believes.

INSIDE THE LIGHT — SCRIPTURE, HISTORY, SCIENCE

Researchers studying hundreds of thousands of posts found that moral-emotional language makes messages spread further within like-minded groups. Tell a machine to chase attention and it learns what grabs us — it doesn't have to hate anyone to divide everyone. Nia's line is the thesis: it's not the AI; it's what we told it to optimize.

ACTIVITY

Audit your feed

1. Scroll your main feed for five minutes. Tally: informed me / connected me / made me mad at someone.
2. Find one account that makes you mad at a group of people. Ask: what is this optimizing?
3. Follow one voice from outside your 'zone' for a week. Write what changed.

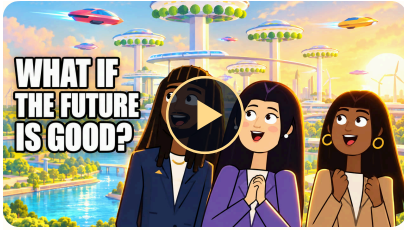
JOURNAL THIS

WHAT IS THIS OPTIMIZING? _____
WHO DOES IT SORT ME AWAY FROM? _____
ONE EDGE I'LL CHOOSE DIFFERENTLY: _____

TALK ABOUT IT

- ☐ Brent says they 'personalized' instead of 'sorted.' What's the difference?
- ☐ 'A Black Jesus, not a Black-only Jesus.' What did Dre mean?
- ☐ Which of your daily habits are edges toward the red branch?

Sources. Brady, W. J. et al. (2017). Emotion shapes the diffusion of moralized content in social networks. PNAS. · Hart, P. E., Nilsson, N. J. & Raphael, B. (1968). A formal basis for the heuristic determination of minimum cost paths (A*). IEEE.



EPISODE 5

The Jetsons Branch

5:04 · Search Party · a Bot That Lyfe study

Pick a heuristic — **does this bring people closer?** — and let it choose your next step.

WHAT IT'S ABOUT

- A* search: how far you've come plus a good guess of how far is left
- What research says about meditation and stress
- How a vision becomes a proposal: the three questions as a plan

WORDS TO KNOW

A* (A-star)

A search that ranks next steps by cost so far plus a heuristic estimate of what's left.

Heuristic

A measurable hunch that points you toward the goal.

Proposal

Where we're at, where we're going, how — and what it costs.

INSIDE THE LIGHT — SCRIPTURE, HISTORY, SCIENCE

A* was introduced by Hart, Nilsson and Raphael in 1968 and still powers maps and games. A good heuristic changes which future you explore first. In a JAMA Internal Medicine meta-analysis, mindfulness meditation programs showed moderate improvements in anxiety, depression and pain — real, modest, worth practicing. The Jetsons branch is fiction; the heuristic is a choice you can make today.

ACTIVITY

Write a Harmony proposal

1. Pick one problem on your campus or block (stress, food, a dirty creek, a divided group).
2. Answer: where are we at, where are we trying to get, how will we get there?
3. Test every step with the heuristic: does this bring people closer together?

JOURNAL THIS

PROBLEM: _____
WHERE WE'RE AT: _____
WHERE TO: _____
HOW: _____
HEURISTIC CHECK: does it bring people closer? yes / no

TALK ABOUT IT

- ☐ Future Brent learned the difference between atmosphere and presence. What is it?
- ☐ What would 'the gold branch' look like on your campus?
- ☐ Brent wanted to vote for his opponent. When has someone else's vision been better than yours?

Sources. Hart, Nilsson & Raphael (1968). A* search. IEEE Transactions on Systems Science and Cybernetics. · Goyal, M. et al. (2014). Meditation programs for psychological stress and well-being: a systematic review and meta-analysis. JAMA Internal Medicine.



EPISODE 6

Light Speed

5:21 · Search Party · a Bot That Lyfe study

Know where you're at, name where you're going, choose how — then **build** it, together.

WHAT IT'S ABOUT

- How a vision becomes a prototype — and why vague prompts break demos
- The whole season's map: breadth, depth, and a good heuristic
- Faith and building: the window, the work, the people

WORDS TO KNOW

Prototype

The first version that works well enough to learn from.

Iteration

Build, test, fix, repeat.

Nobel Prizes

Awarded in physics, chemistry, physiology or medicine, literature and peace (plus an economics prize) — there is no Nobel in mathematics. Math's top honors are the Fields Medal and the Abel Prize.

INSIDE THE LIGHT — SCRIPTURE, HISTORY, SCIENCE

Every episode asked the same three questions; the finale answers them together. The science in the Harmony Stack is a sketch, not a spec — but the method is real: name the state, name the goal, choose the path, test it on people, and keep the heuristic honest. 'There's no Nobel in mathematics' is true. 'There is now' is the show.

ACTIVITY

Your Harmony Stack

1. Pick one thing from the season you want to build — a habit, a project, a group.
2. Write the three questions for it. Make the goal something you could show someone.
3. Do the first step in the next 48 hours. Tell someone.

JOURNAL THIS

WHERE YOU AT? _____
WHERE YOU TRYING TO GET? _____
HOW YOU GETTING THERE? _____
WHO'S SEARCHING WITH YOU? _____

TALK ABOUT IT

- ☐ Ms. Lorraine says the new window is 'still Him.' What changed and what didn't?
- ☐ What was Brent's turn — and what made it real?
- ☐ What's the first thing you'll build, and who's in your search party?

Sources. The Nobel Prize — [nobelprize.org](https://www.nobelprize.org) (prize categories). · International Mathematical Union — Fields Medal; Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters — Abel Prize.

The season on one page

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EPISODE 3

Same Light

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EPISODE 4

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EPISODE 6

Light Speed

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THE THREE QUESTIONS

WHERE I'M AT:

WHERE I'M TRYING TO GET:

HOW I'M GETTING THERE:

ONE STEP THIS WEEK:

YOUR SEARCH STRATEGY

MY SEARCH STYLE: wide (BFS) / deep (DFS) /
stuck at the start

GOING DEEPER ON: -----

I'LL KNOW I'M THERE WHEN: -----

I'LL TURN AROUND IF: -----

KEEP GOING

New animated series every week — faith, AI, engineering, the real world — with free study guides at bothatlyfe.com. Questions or want this for your class or team? nate@autonateai.com